

GARLIC *Allium sativum*

Its distinct aroma and strong flavor make garlic a vital component of many of our everyday dishes, and it is also known for its medicinal properties and health benefits. Despite needing a relatively long growing period, it is very easy to grow, even in cooler climates, making it a popular choice with gardeners. Garlic can either be planted straight into the ground, or indoors in module trays to be planted out once it has sprouted.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
PLANT				
HARVEST				

PLANTING

Garlic grows best in a sunny, open site with fertile, well-drained, and mildly alkaline soil. Plant in fall or early winter, since garlic needs cold weather at the start of its growth. Spring planted garlic will still succeed, but it does tend to produce smaller bulbs, since there is less time for it to mature.

To plant, split open a bulb and divide it into individual cloves. Push these about 4 in (10 cm) deep into the soil with their points facing up, either directly into the ground or in modules. Space the plants 8 in (20 cm) apart.

CROP CARE

Plant it in the right conditions and garlic is relatively easy to grow. Keep it well-weeded, and



Create deep holes for bulbs with a dibber.

water it so that the soil is kept fairly moist; be careful not to overwater. If the weather is cold, consider giving plants some protection with a cloche.

Watch for signs of bolting, since this will decrease the final size of the bulb. To prevent this from happening, cut the stem down to about half its height a couple of weeks prior to harvesting.